

1. Health and Safety Policy

Every employer must promote their employees' health and safety. Here are some policies that ensure a safe and healthy work environment:

- **OSHA compliance:** References all OSHA regulations relevant to the work environment.
- **Incident response plans:** Detailed plans for what to do during a workplace emergency or incident.
- **Working hour limits:** Expectations and restrictions for how long employees should work.
- **Violation procedures:** Guidelines for how to report unsafe behavior to the appropriate people.

2. Equal Employment Opportunity Policy

U.S. labor laws require employers to treat job candidates equally, without racial, gender or ethnic discrimination. This policy ensures that employers consider all individuals fairly, and there are severe consequences for violating it. To comply, your employment contracts, application process and employee handbook must meet all the requirements set by the [U.S. Commission on Civil Rights](#).

3. Employee Behavior and Conduct Policy

Ideally, you can trust you've hired people with integrity who know how to make good decisions. But some misconduct like harassment and discrimination must be strictly prohibited to create clear workplace expectations. Your code of conduct should outline what constitutes acceptable behavior and the disciplinary actions employees should expect if they fail to comply.

4. Attendance and Punctuality Policy

Employers rely on team members during regular working hours to manage meetings, events and collaborative projects accordingly. To set expectations, your code of conduct should outline regular working hours, a paid time off policy and vacation days so everyone is on the same schedule.

5. Social Media Policy

Marketing teams work hard to establish a social media presence that reflects the business's brand and speaks to your target audience. Poorly worded posts can quickly eliminate all the goodwill your social accounts have built. A social media policy helps you avoid this by setting guidelines about what employees can and can't share online.

6. Device Usage Policy

If your employees use company devices to complete their work, you must have [policies and procedures](#) for procuring and returning those items. Without documented rules, your IT department can be overwhelmed with questions about how to request or install equipment.

7. Confidentiality Policy

Your employee handbook should include clear guidelines about what constitutes confidential information. If you have an [internal knowledge base](#), for example, you should set a policy declaring whether employees can share it with potential clients and outside contractors. These guidelines prevent team members from committing accidental compliance violations.

8. Remote Work Policy

If you allow remote work, outline the expectations employees must meet when they're offsite. For example, a remote work policy typically includes guidelines for security compliance, such as only using secure internet connections. Also, define how remote work impacts working hours so people can adjust their schedules accordingly.

9. Policy Review Procedure

Policy documents must include a process for updating as the business grows. Employees should be encouraged to give feedback and start a review. Even if a rule stays the same, this input ensures everyone's voice is valued.